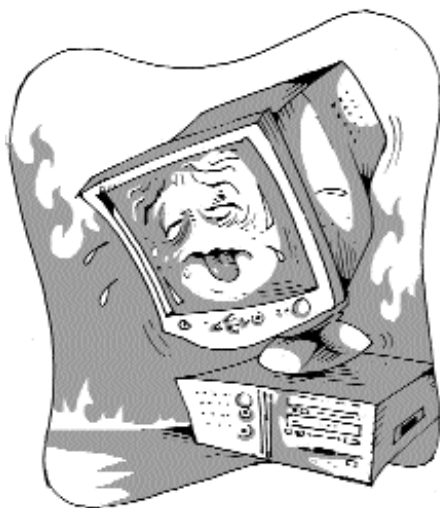


## 1.5 Common Symptoms and Precautions

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The problem about virus attacks is that unless your anti-virus tells you, you have no way of being sure that your computer is not infected. Still, there are a few symptoms that you should look out for. These include:

- Your computer always stops responding when you try to use certain software. This could also take place due to corruption of an essential file required by that software.
- You received an e-mail message that has a strange attachment. When you open the attachment, dialog boxes appear, or a sudden degradation in system performance occurs.
- There is a double extension on an attachment that you recently opened, such as .jpg .vbs or .gif. exe.
- An anti-virus program is disabled for no reason and it cannot be restarted. The computer may not allow re-installation of the anti-virus.